

LEAD OPPONENT SCOUTING REPORT

Opponent: UCLA Bruins

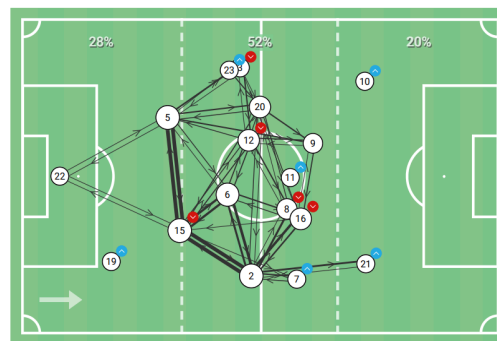
Date of Match: 09/19

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Opponent Record: 1-2-3 (only win: 1-0 vs Northwestern, most recent & 1st conference match)

Overall Team Overview:

UCLA is a possession-focused team (55.8% avg.) that builds through its back four and two central midfielders (#6, #12) but will go long when space is available, often targeting #9 — a strong, fast striker who stretches the back line. They overload centrally to progress play, then shift wide to isolate dribblers, particularly on the right (#2, #7). #20 links midfield and attack, drifting across the lines, while LB #3 is highly involved but turnover-prone. Defensively, they're organized but vulnerable: 3 of their last 6 goals conceded came from crosses (2 from corners), aerial duel success is low (36.9%), and the fullbacks often leave space in behind for runners. Set-piece balls are also a weakness. Opponents have had success exploiting wide areas early and targeting space behind the defense.



Passing matrix vs Northwestern

PPDA	9.4	Moderately aggressive press — look to press after turnovers in midfield.
Average Possession %	55.8%	Prefers to control the game, especially through the center.
Passes per Possession	67.3	Varies by opponent; generally high vs weaker teams (up to 76).
xG per 90	0.86	Modest attacking output; not consistently high-threat.
Long Pass %	8.3%	Will go long when space is available — especially toward #9.
Average Pass Length	19.4 yds	Balanced — not overly short or direct.

In Possession:

- Shape: 4-2-3-1 or 4-1-4-1
- Buildup through back 4 and CMs (#6, #12); GK moderately involved
- Left side for buildup (LB #3 active), right side for dribbles (via #2, #7)
- #20 drifts to connect lines
- #9 frequently targeted on long/through balls

Out of Possession:

- Defensive shape: 4-4-2 or 4-1-4-1 mid-block
- Moderate pressing intensity (PPDA ~9.4); press triggers mainly in midfield
- Compact centrally — forces opponents wide
- Weak at defending crosses, set-piece balls, and aerial duels

Key Players:

- #9 – Sergi Solans (ST)
 - Right footed, strong, quick
 - Alert in the box
- #6 – Tarun Karumanchi (CDM)
 - Comfortable on the ball
 - Looking to switch long balls